



THE ROAD
TEMPLATES & WORKBOOKS



Scan the code for more workbooks

Self-Surrender & Prison Prep Checklist

Getting your life and your affairs in order before you report.

If the court has allowed you to self-surrender, you have something most people in custody never get: time to prepare. Use it. The weeks before you report are for settling your affairs, protecting the people who depend on you, and walking in steady. This checklist is what to handle, roughly in order.

Your lawyer and, for federal cases, the Bureau of Prisons designation control the real details: where and when you report, and what you may bring. Confirm everything with them. This is the general map, not your specific orders.

Confirm the basics with your lawyer

- ☐ The exact date, time, and place you must report. Get it in writing.
- ☐ Whether you self-surrender to the facility or to the U.S. Marshals.
- ☐ Your designated facility, and whether a designation is still pending.
- ☐ What you are allowed to bring on the day, which is usually very little.
- ☐ Whether any surrender date extension is possible if you have a real need.

Money and bills

- ☐ Set up automatic payment or a trusted person for rent, mortgage, insurance, and utilities.
- ☐ Decide who has access to funds and how bills get paid while you are away.
- ☐ Arrange a way to put money on your commissary and phone account.
- ☐ Cancel or pause subscriptions and anything that will pile up.

People and responsibilities

- ☐ Put childcare and any caregiving in writing, with the people who will handle it.
- ☐ Consider a power of attorney so someone can act for you. Ask your lawyer.
- ☐ Write down every account, password, and key contact for the person managing your affairs.
- ☐ Tell your employer what you have decided to tell them, and no more.

Health

- ☐ Get copies of your medical and mental health records and current medication list.
- ☐ Note anything the facility medical staff must know on arrival.
- ☐ Schedule any dental or medical care you can complete before you report.

The day you report

- ☐ Arrive early. Bring only what you were told you may bring, plus required documents.
- ☐ Have a small amount of cash for your account if permitted, in the form they specify.
- ☐ Bring the names, addresses, and numbers of the people you will want to contact, on paper.
- ☐ Arrange your ride so no one has to wait; goodbyes are easier short.

Key details

Report date, time, place: _____

Facility: _____

Person managing my affairs, and how to reach them:

This workbook is educational and reflects lived and professional experience. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship.

Laws and procedures vary by jurisdiction and change over time. For advice about your situation, consult a licensed attorney in your state.

More free tools and guidance: hub.newphysician.org/templates · bustedbythefed.com · whitecollaracademy.com

The Road · Templates & Workbooks